

Listing photo

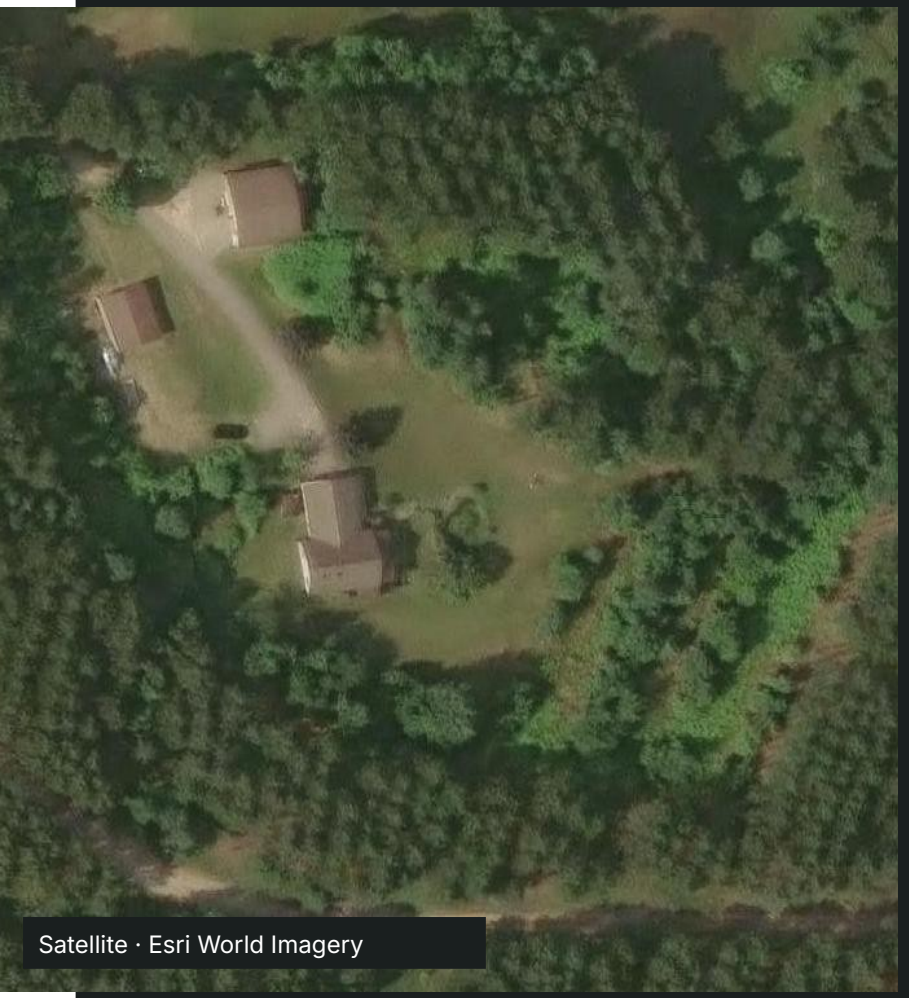
5312 Samels Rd Project Vision

Clark Huang & Jenny Roes · Williamsburg, near Traverse City, MI

Live 3D model and site: clarkhuang.github.io/5312-samels-rd

October 2026

SAMELS RD



Satellite · Esri World Imagery

Six wooded acres, a 1997 chalet, four buildings

6.00 acres

Wooded, sloped lot ~698 × 413 ft with ~40 ft of relief. Zoned A-1 Agricultural, Whitewater Twp. Private gravel road.

2,380 sf chalet

1.5-story, built 1997: 1,480 sf above grade + 900 sf walk-out lower. Metal roof, propane forced air, central air.

4 bed · 3 bath

2 main, 1 loft, 1 lower; 2 full + 1 ¾ bath. Lower family room 29′9″ × 19′9″. Lily pond east of the deck.

4 buildings

Pole barn 32 × 38 (insulated, subpanel), second garage ~28 × 30 (est.), attached 2-car garage, small shed.

Site plan

The chalet sits mid-lot, ~200 ft off Samels Rd. Deck and walk-out face east to the pond; both barns cluster at the drive. Guest suite spot is a future option only.





Today · listing photo

Concept rendering · after the project

From the air, after

Deck stained brown; siding unchanged. Cream barns with brown-frame glass doors. A ~52-panel ground-mount array in the field, not on the roofs. Fire pit by the pond; van and pontoon by the big barn. Guest suite left out here.

Above the trees: array in the field, suite later



Concept rendering · wide view



Concept rendering · with future guest suite

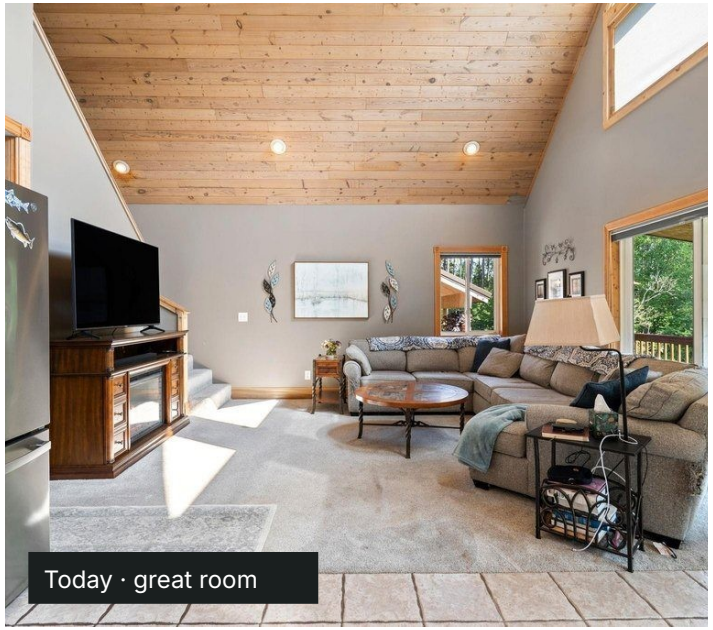
Edited from listing drone photos p59 and p60. Right: Phase 2 guest suite on the west side, shown as future. Positions and sizes are concepts, not surveyed; the array and suite need permits and setback checks.

Modern, not country: one idea per level



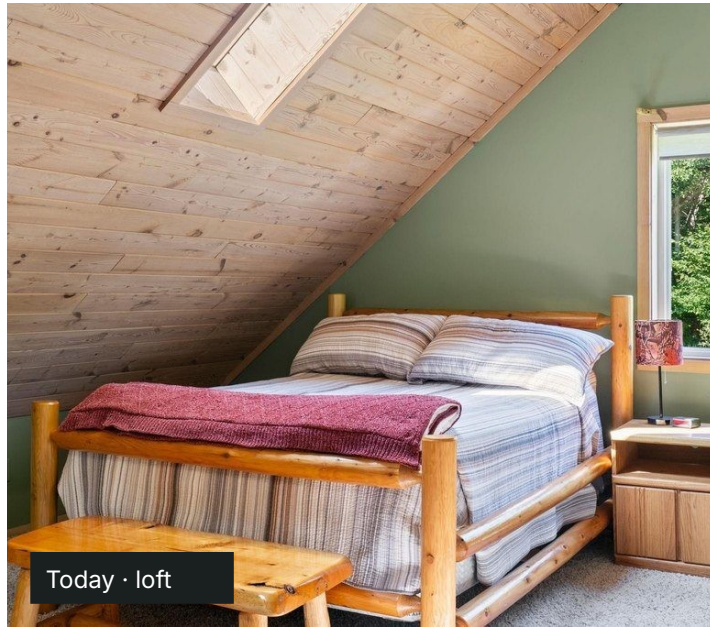
Lower · master retreat

Clean, fresh, modern and cozy: primary suite, sitting/TV room, morning coffee at the walk-out.



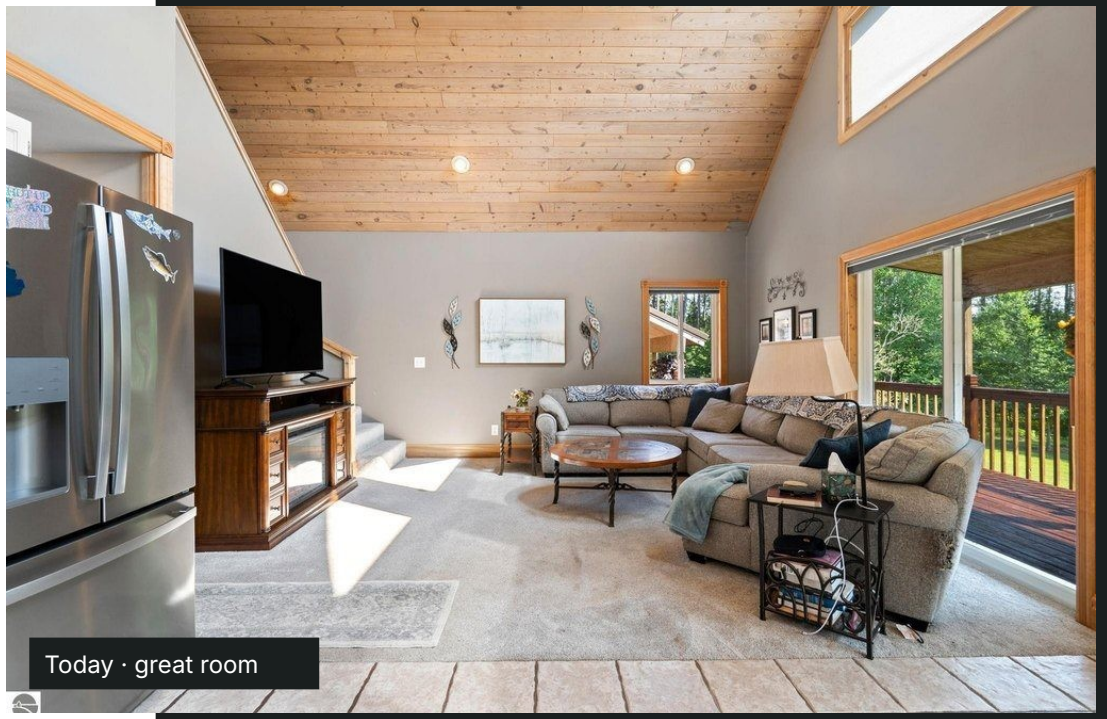
Main · entertaining

Lounge under the kept pine ceiling, island for four, two offices (one doubles for guests); dinners on the deck.

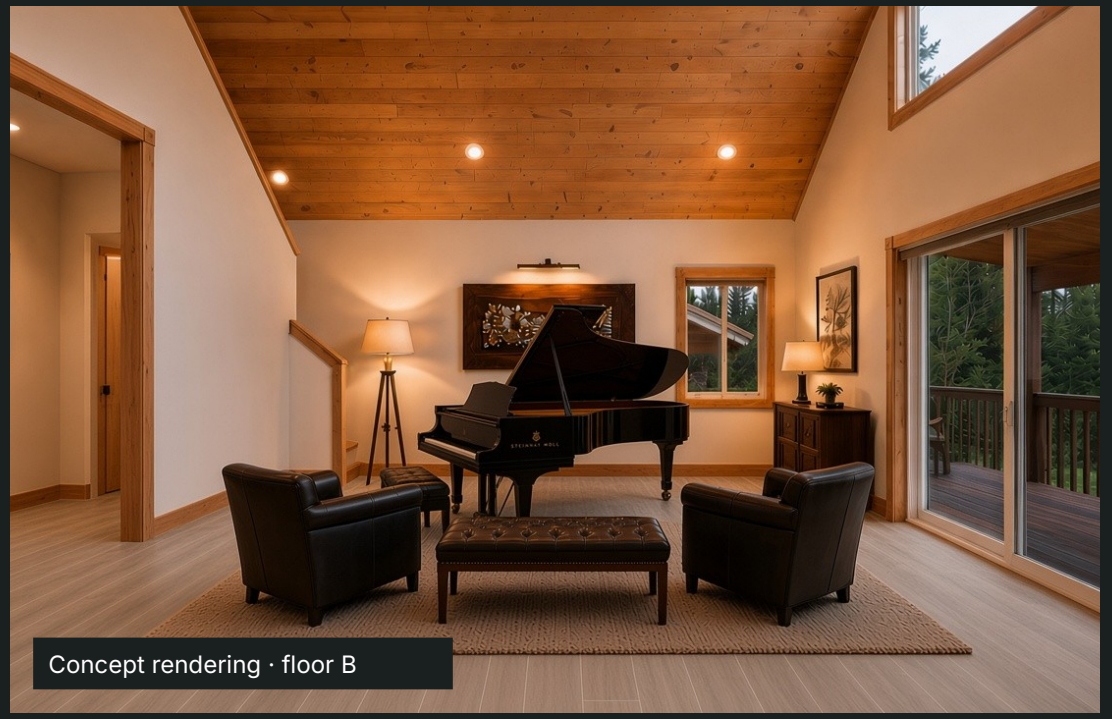


Loft · guests

Guest loft: a twin under the eave plus a queen. Warm white walls, oak floor; pine kept (paint optional).



Today · great room



Concept rendering · floor B

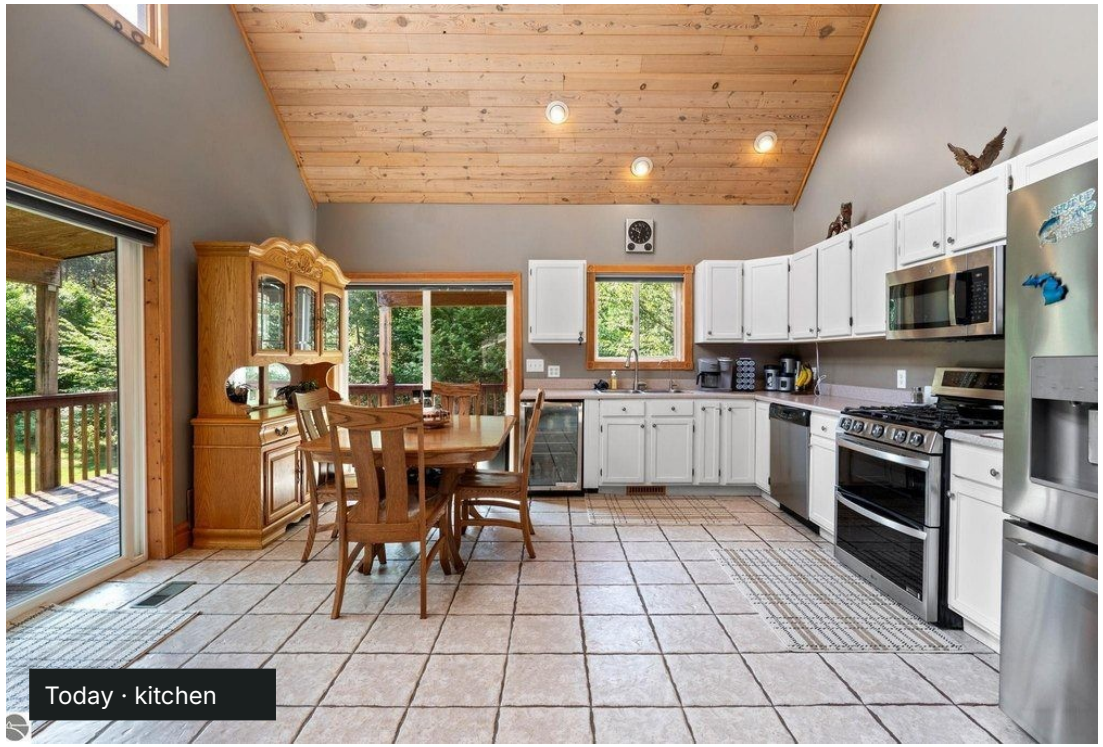
Great room: a lounge under the pine ceiling

Keeps the knotty-pine ceiling and honey trim; warm white walls and lamplight work with the wood; shown with gray plank floor B (oak A on slide 19). The Steinway B (6′11″ × 4′10″) is centered in the lounge as the focal piece, with a light conversation group: two cigar chairs and the tufted bench; the club sofa is dropped. Keyboard faces east, lid opens north; ~3 ft to the south and office walls, 4.7 ft to the stair, ~12 ft from the east glass (3D model).

Fit result: the old dining spot by the stair failed in the 3D model (~1.2 ft behind the stools, 0.5 ft to the rail), so the piano moves into the lounge.

Island for four, under the same wood

Kitchen 14 ft and dining 15 ft (listing, one dimension each). A ~9 × 4.1 ft quartz island with 13-in charcoal storage cabinets on the seating side, a 12–13 in overhang and four stools takes the dining table's spot: 46-in work aisle, ~7.5 ft behind the stools (3D model; verify at the visit). $6K / $11K / $20K (est.). Cabinets, appliances and the pine ceiling stay; the oak hutch leaves with the sellers. Dinners move to the deck (6-ft round teak, ~$4,369).



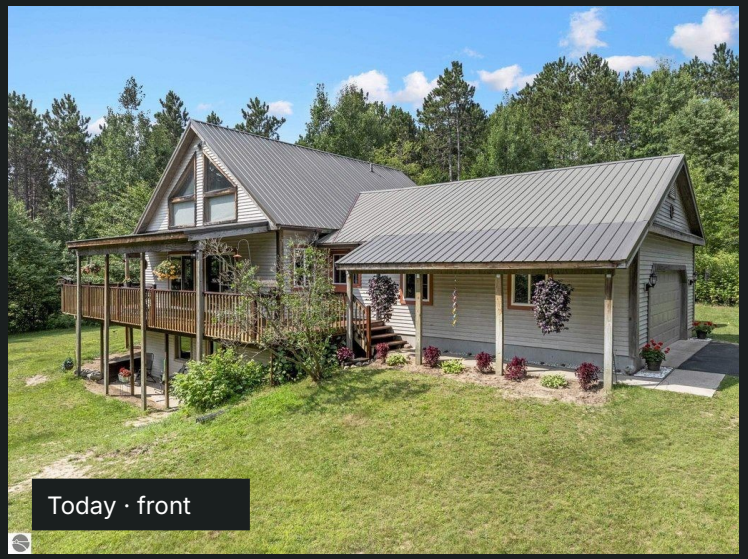
Today · kitchen



Concept rendering · floor B



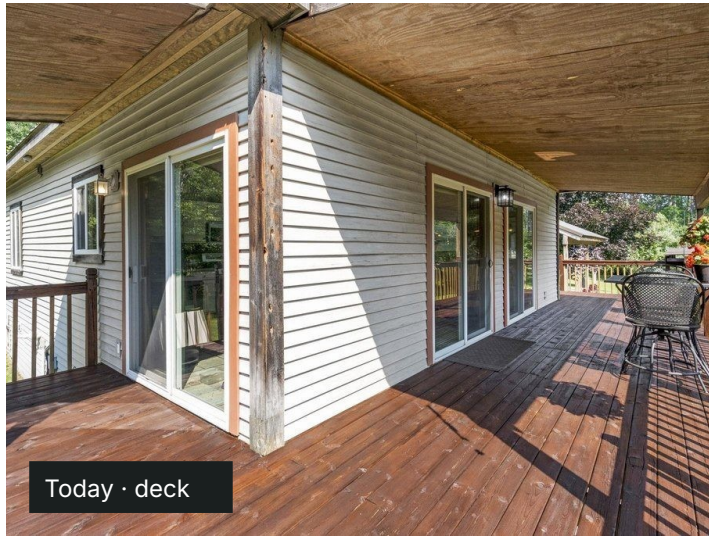
Concept rendering · deck + rails brown



Today · front

The light sage-gray vinyl siding, metal roof and brown window trim stay as they are. Only the deck boards, posts and rails get a solid brown stain, with a 6-ft teak table on the deck.

~$1–4K, mid $2.5K (est.)


Today · deck


Concept rendering · brown (pick)

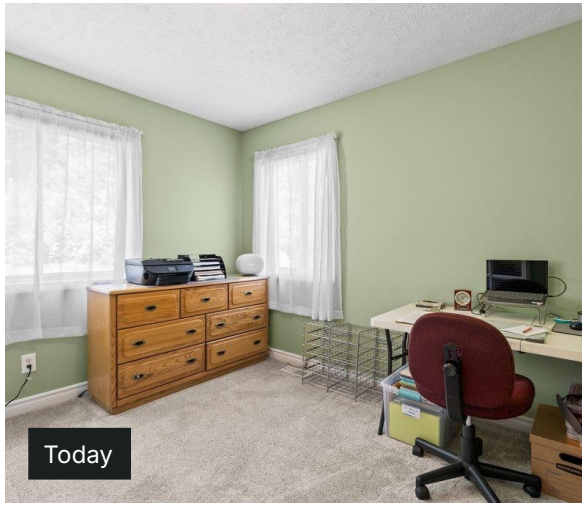

Concept rendering · cream

Deck + rails: brown or cream

The vinyl siding stays as it is (light sage-gray, brown window trim). Brown repeats the window trim and the new brown barn-door frames; cream picks up the barns' cream steel.

~$1–4K, mid $2.5K (est.) for a pro clean + solid stain, ~320 sf + ~55 LF of rail.

Main floor: two offices, one guest overflow



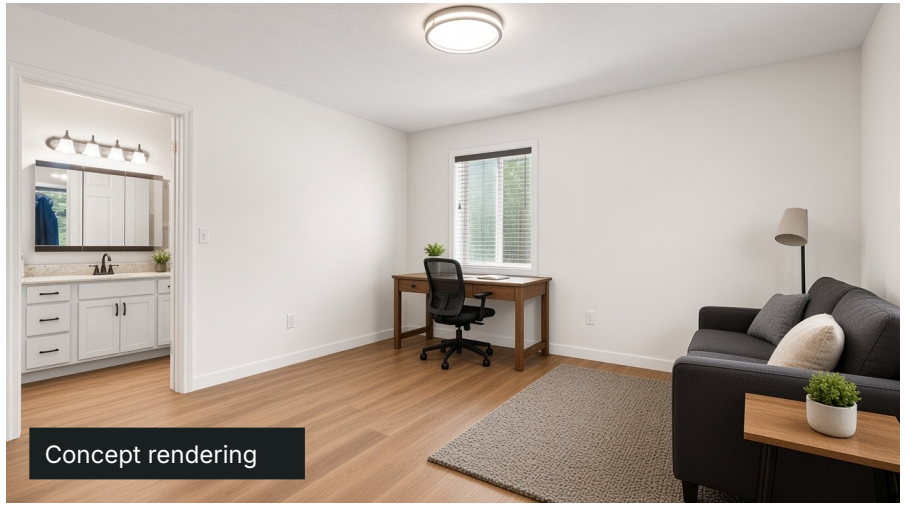


Office · 11 × 9 ft

Bedroom 3 (listing). Seabreeze glass-top desk + Aeron facing the window, one low credenza. Desk ~5 × 2.5 ft (est., not logged) + ~3 ft chair zone leaves ~3 ft clear.







Office + guest · 13 × 13 ft

Today's primary (listing); keeps its direct door to the main bath. Second desk + full sleeper sofa (~7 × 3 ft closed, ~7 × 7 open, est.). Opened, ~3 ft stays clear to the bath and hall.

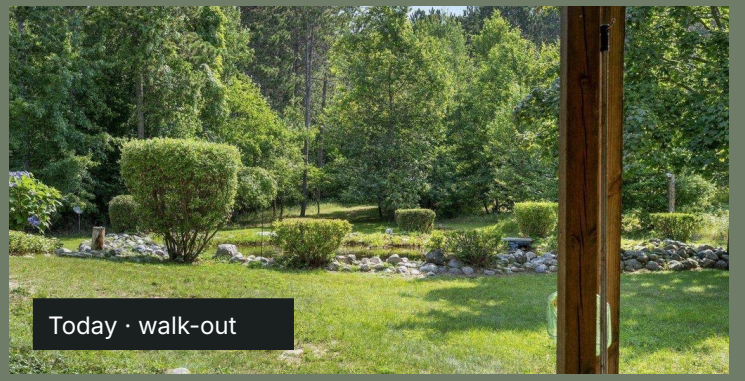




Concept rendering



Today · lower bedroom



Today · walk-out

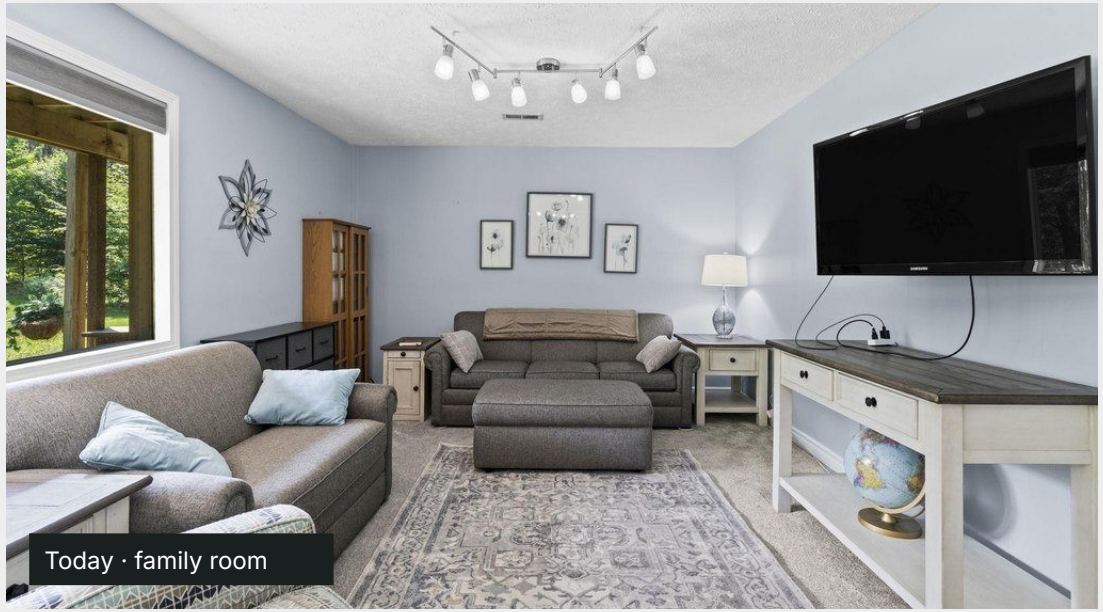
Lower master: a king, nothing extra

Bedroom 4 · 15 × 12 ft (listing). A king (6′4″ × 6′8″) and two 2-ft nightstands on the 15-ft wall leave ~2.3 ft each side and ~5 ft at the foot. New king (none in the Seabreeze inventory).

Solid doors replace the French doors; morning coffee out the walk-out. Check egress: ≥5.7 sf open, sill ≤44 in.

Lower sitting / TV room

Family room 29 × 19 ft (listing). Clark’s big Seabreeze sectional (~12 × 10 ft L, verify; not logged) tucks into a corner facing the 75″ TV on the white console, for lounging and movies. That leaves the walk-out side open with 3+ ft paths; one large rug softens the floor.



Today · family room



Concept rendering · floor B





Guest loft: twin under the eave, queen beside

Bedroom 2 · 19 × 14 ft (listing), sloped pine ceiling kept. Twin (3′3″ × 6′3″) runs lengthwise under the low slope; queen (5′ × 6′8″) sits at full height beside it, with ~3 ft between beds and a clear path to the stair (est.; measure the knee wall). Sleeps three.

Lower bath: two options

Today ~5 × 9 ft (est.; the listing gives no bath sizes).
Long, narrow: vanity, toilet, 5-ft tub.


Concept rendering · A

A · Keep the footprint

$18–30K (est.)

Walk-in shower with glass panel, large warm-greige porcelain, 60-in floating oak double vanity, LED mirror light, matching toilet.

Fit: tight. 60-in vanity + toilet + ~32-in shower ≈ 10 ft vs ~9 ft (est.); may need a 48-in vanity.


Today · lower bath


Concept rendering · B

B · Borrow the craft room

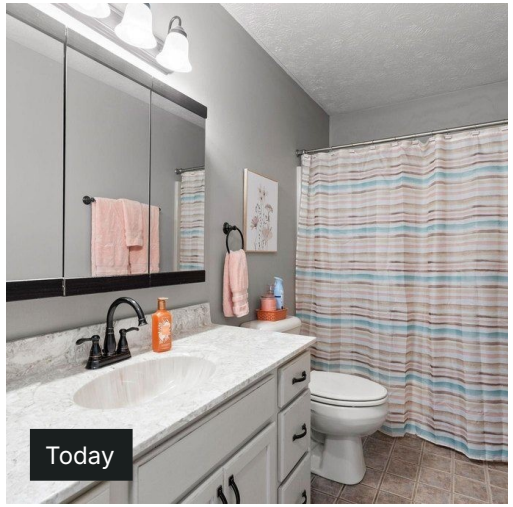
$34.5K / $49.3K / $74K (est.)

Freestanding tub, separate glass shower, 60–72-in double vanity, porcelain over a radiant mat, sconces, matching toilet.

Fit: comfortable at ~9 × 12 (est.); moves 1 non-bearing wall. This is the base budget.

Main bath: same tub-shower, two finishes

Both keep the 60-in acrylic tub-shower footprint, so no walls move. The office/guest room keeps its direct door. Size not in the listing (~6 × 6 ft in the 3D model, est.).



Today

Partly updated

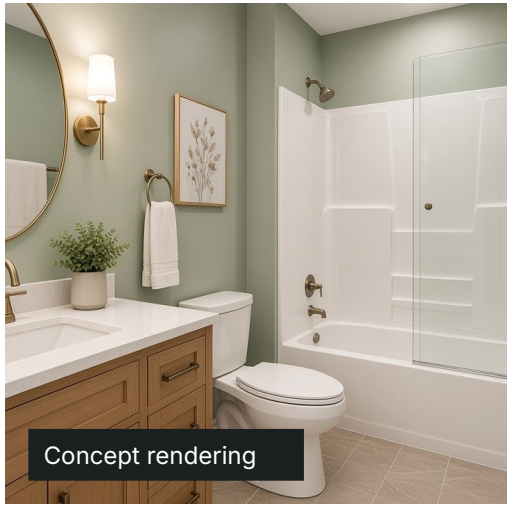
Gray vanity, cultured marble top, tub/shower with a curtain, tile floor.



A · Refresh

$8K / $12K / $18K (est.)

New acrylic tub-shower + sliding glass, keep the gray vanity with a quartz top, black fixtures, oak LVP.



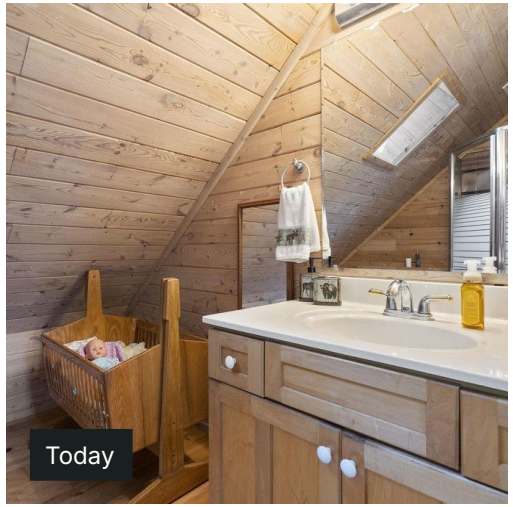
B · New vanity

$9K / $14K / $22K (est.)

Same tub-shower + hinged glass, oak vanity + quartz, brass fixtures, porcelain floor, sage walls.

Loft ¾ bath: shower only, no tub

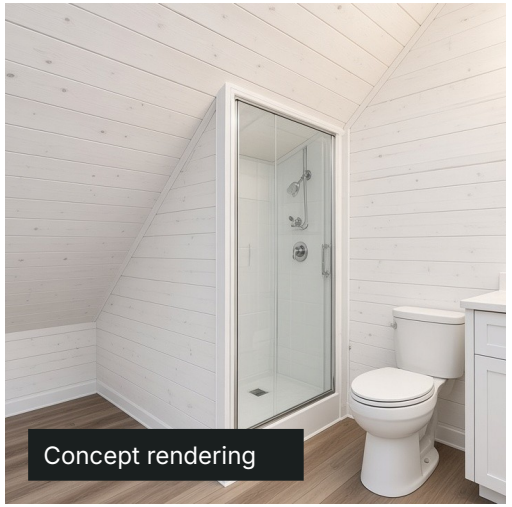
~45–60 sf (est., notes) under the roof slope. Keep the shower where there is full headroom; measure the slope before ordering.



Today

The most rustic room

Pine plank walls and ceiling, oak vanity, neo-angle corner shower.



A · Acrylic shower

$9.5K / $14.3K / $23K (est.)

Multi-piece acrylic shower, 30-in white vanity, pine painted white, oak LVP floor.



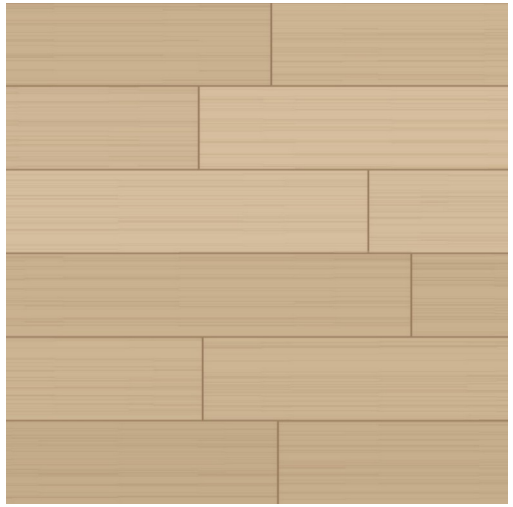
B · Tiled shower

$13.5K / $21.3K / $35K (est.)

Tiled shower + glass panel, oak vanity, pine kept natural, porcelain floor.

Finishes: light, quiet, continuous

Cosmetic only. Nothing structural inside the house. Mid estimates.



Floors

~$18K mid (est.)

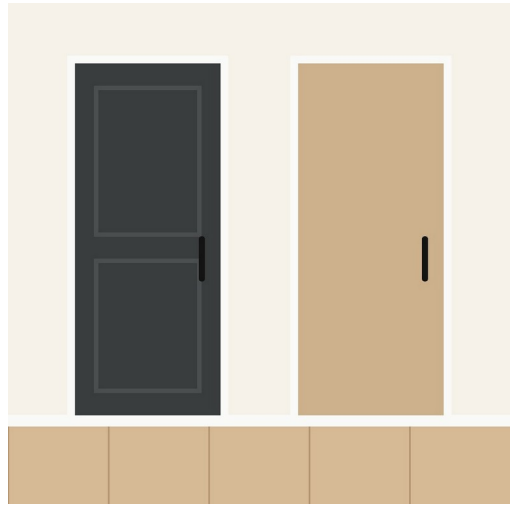
One oak-tone waterproof plank on every level, porcelain in the baths. See the flooring plan.



Paint

~$9–15K mid (est.)

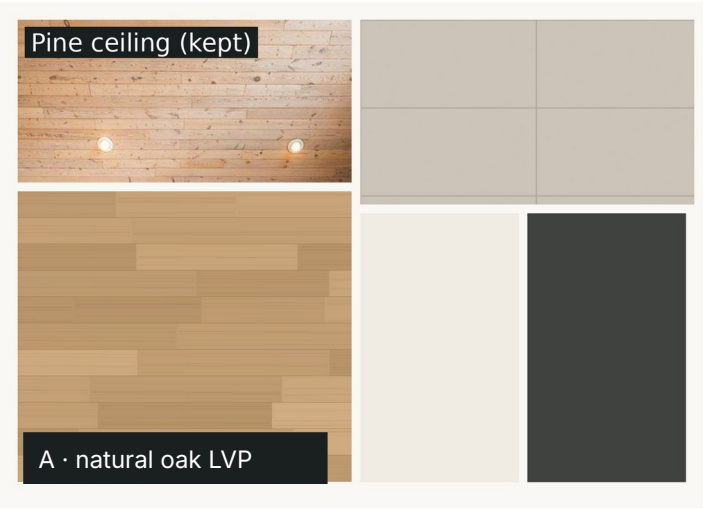
Warm white walls. Keep the great-room pine ceiling and trim; paint the loft pine only if wanted.

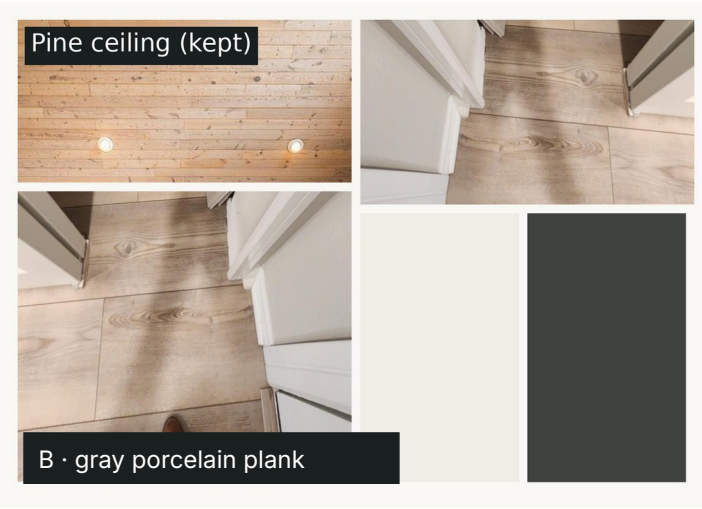


Doors & closets

~$13.5K mid (est.)

Modern slab or shaker doors, finished closets with doors; close off 1–2 openings, e.g. the lower French doors.





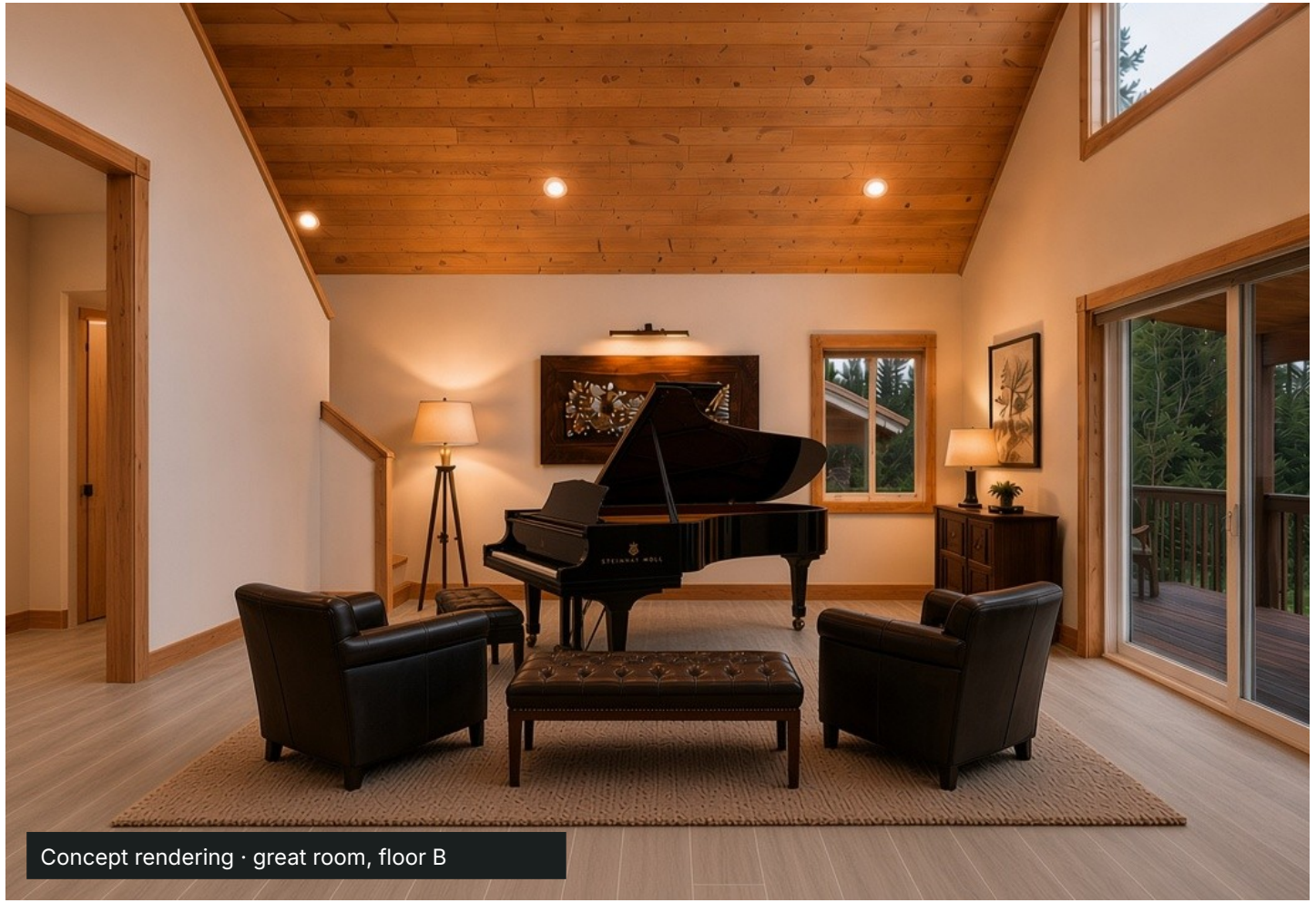
Flooring: A or B, under the pine

A · Natural oak LVP: warm, soft underfoot, quiet. ~$6.50–14/sf installed with tear-out → $13K / $18K / $28K.

B · Gray porcelain plank (8×48 or 9×48 in): soft driftwood gray like Clark's Florida floors; waterproof, ideal with radiant heat, baths and the walk-out. Colder and harder, so add rugs. ~$9–20/sf installed + tear-out → ~$21K / $33K / $43K.



Option B: gray plank tile under the wood ceiling



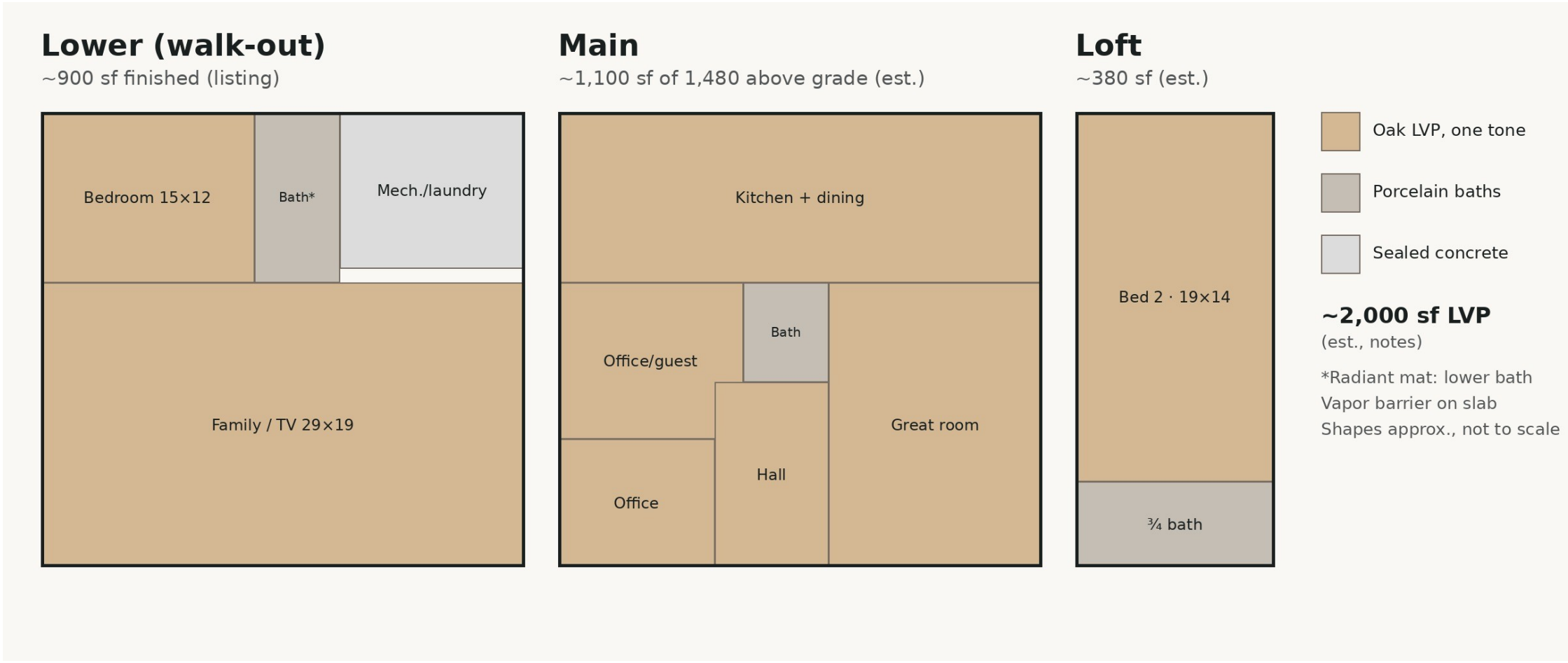
Concept rendering · great room, floor B



Concept rendering · bath, floor B

Cool gray floor, warm pine ceiling, cream rugs in between. The same 8×48 in plank runs into the curbless shower; furniture sizes as on the room slides. Lower TV room in B: slide 13.

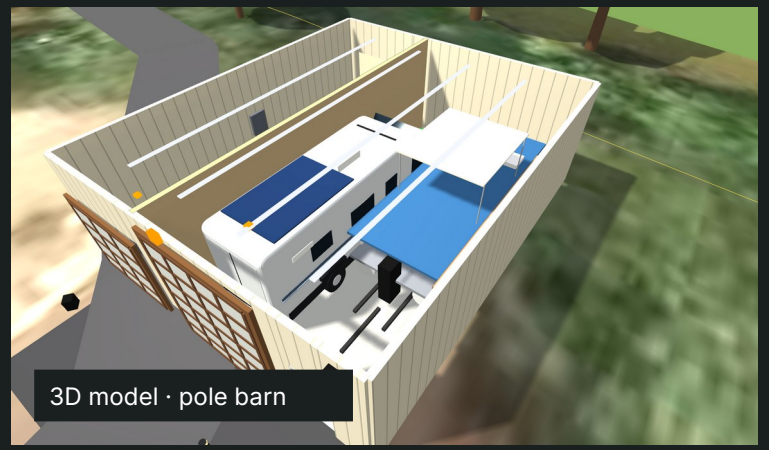
Flooring plan by level (A or B)



A oak LVP ≈ $13K / $18K / $28K · B gray porcelain plank ≈ $21K / $33K / $43K (est., ~2,000 sf). Same plan for both; B suits radiant heat, baths and the walk-out. Radiant mat to be quoted.



Concept rendering



3D model · pole barn

Big barn: van + pontoon

Pole barn 32 × 38, insulated, with a subpanel. No structural work.

Large section

2022 Airstream Interstate 24X, a Class B camper van on a 2021 Mercedes Sprinter 3500 dually (~24 ft), plus the pontoon boat. The tall overhead door fits the van (confirmed in person).

Divider + power

Remove the interior divider only if it is a non-load-bearing partition (~$1–3K, est.). Add 50 A shore power for the van off the barn subpanel.

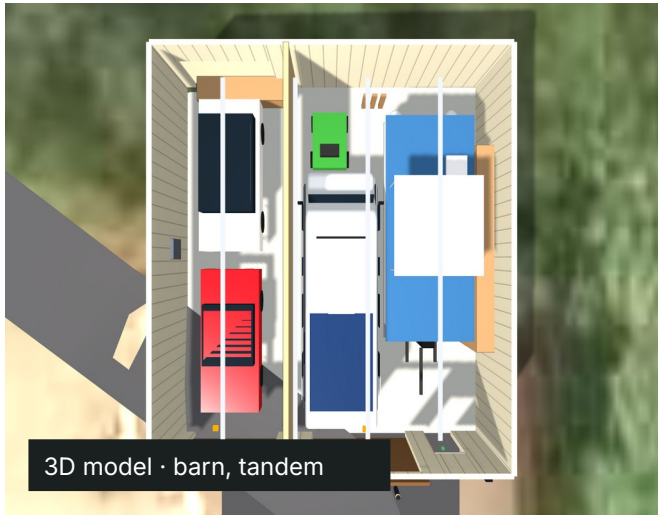


3D model · garage

~10 ft

Garage: Model Y + XT5

Side by side in the 24 × 24 attached garage, ~10 ft of walkway left. Tesla Wall Connector on the west wall.



3D model · barn, tandem

~4.3 ft

Barn: van + pontoon

Large section (~19.5 ft wide): Airstream 24X + pontoon side by side leave ~4.3 ft. Tight with mirrors out; no third vehicle.



Today · pole barn doors

9 × 8

Small side: tandem

911 + Model Y nose to tail in the ~11.5 ft section: 30.6 ft of cars in 37.3 ft if the back workbench moves. New 9 × 8 glass door: A front (pick, $9–17K) or B rear gable ($11–22K). Mower behind the van.

Pole barn, glass doors

Cream steel siding stays. The tall van door and a new 9 × 8 small-section door become full-view glass with brown frames; the man door turns brown with a lite.

Small-section door

9 × 8

Doors + header

$26–45K



Today · pole barn



Concept rendering

Concept	Doors + header (est.)
Glass lites, cream siding	$26–45K · mid $34K

Modern barn doors with glass panels

Full-view or partial-glass overhead doors with brown (or cream) frames and trim; the existing cream steel siding stays. Three doors: the tall van door, a new 9 × 8 for the small section (front, Option A, or rear, Option B), and the gym's 8-ft door.

Full-view aluminum/glass (Clopay Avante type): 9×8 installed $6.8–12.6K; gym 8×7 $5.4–9K; header $1.8–3.5K. Glass costs more than steel. The tall van door is custom: ~$12–20K planning, by quote.



Concept rendering



3D model · concept



Concept rendering · gym + recovery

Small barn: CrossFit gym + recovery room

Train: pull-up rig as the centerpiece, barbells + bumper plates, rower/SkiErg, Peloton, curved treadmill, rubber floor. Most gear moves from Seabreeze.

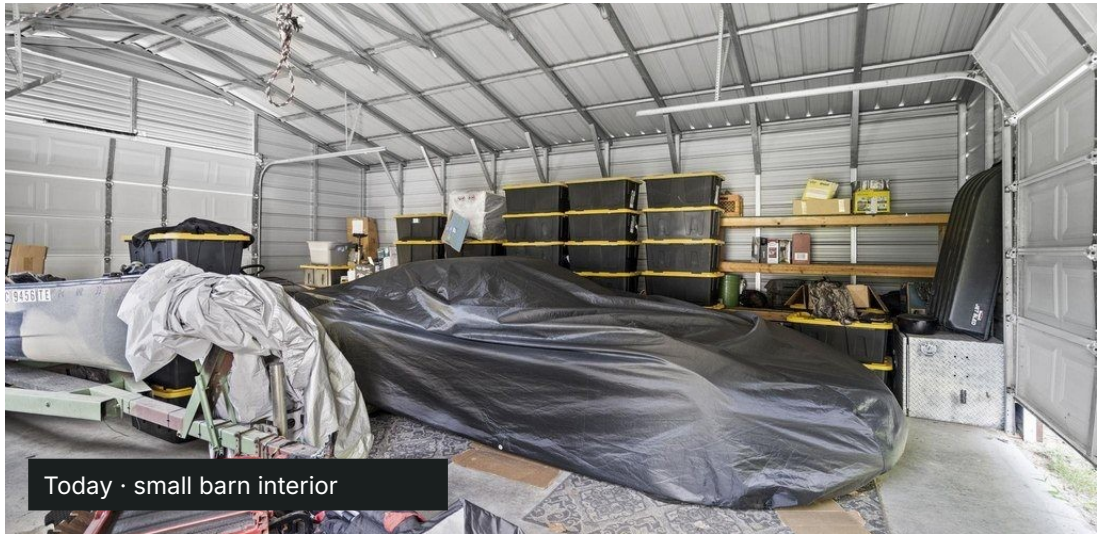
Recover: Clark's white Plunge cold plunge, a cedar glass-front sauna and the Seabreeze massage chair (~32 × 60 in reclined, verify) with ~2 ft clear. The room is climate-controlled: spray foam, a cold-climate mini-split and a dehumidifier. Gym line ~$33K (est.). Optional: Plunge "The Sauna" Standard (5′8″ W × 5′11″ D × 7′11″ H) $11,040 sale / $12,990 list + 240 V 30 A circuit.

Permit: no permit on record, so the second barn needs an after-the-fact permit with Grand Traverse County Construction Codes before new work.

Barn insulation + freeze protection

Small barn (gym + recovery), Phase 1: closed-cell spray foam on ~2,100 sf (~$3.8–7.4K; also a vapor barrier by the plunge), a cold-climate ~18k BTU mini-split ($4.3–5.8K installed) and a dehumidifier at 45–50% RH (~$0.3–2K) → ~$8.6–18.4K, in the gym line.

Big barn van bay, optional: (a) winterize the van and keep shore power, ~$0–300; (b) pick: foam the van bay + a vented Hot Dawg propane heater at 40°F, ~$6–11K; (c) the whole barn, ~$5–16K. Vented heaters only, plus a CO alarm.



Today · small barn interior



Today · pole barn



Concept rendering

Solar in the open field, not on the roofs

Array (concept)

~20 kW ground mount

Storage (optional)

Powerwall 3 · 13.5 kWh each

Why ground: snow and shade. A south-facing rack at 40–50° sheds snow and can be cleared by hand; wooded roofs could lose 20–50%.

Size: ~22,500 kWh/yr use → ~19 kW unshaded, 22–25 kW with shading (~50–60 panels). ~$3.00–3.80/W ≈ $60–76K for 20 kW (est.); ~20–25 yr payback.

Backup: optional central Powerwall 3 system at the house (2 units ~$24–32K, est.), outside the Phase 1 total; stay grid-tied.

Network: UniFi Cloud Gateway Ultra + PoE switch, 5 U7 Pro APs (lower, main, loft, pole barn, gym), 2 U7 Outdoor (deck/pond, solar field), building bridges to both barns.

Security: 7–8 Ring Spotlight Cam Pro (plug-in, hard-wired power) + a Ring Wired Doorbell Pro.

Access + comfort: 4 Yale Assure Lock 2 (entry, walk-out, both barn man doors), 2 ecobee Premium, 4 myQ garage controls.

EV: Tesla Wall Connector in the attached garage.

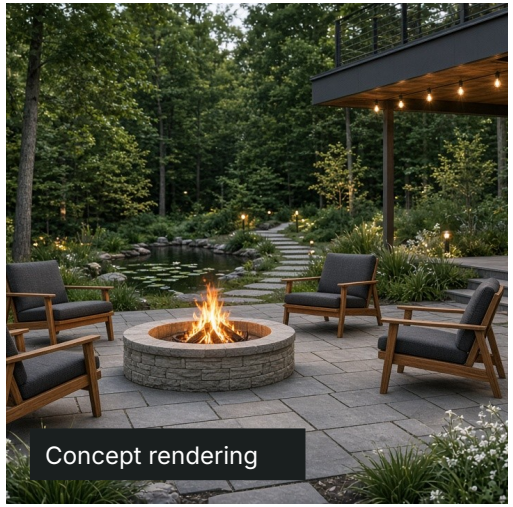


Tech, security & smart home

Hardware ~$6K; about $8–12K installed (mid $10K, est.).

A few extras worth planning

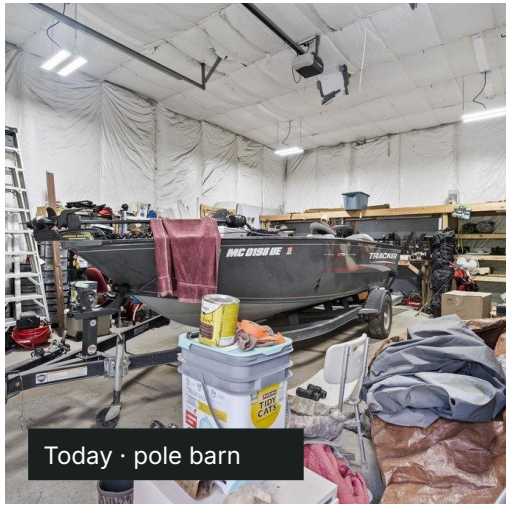
Estimate ranges (est.), not quotes.



Fire pit + landscaping

~$8.7–39.6K (est.)

Fire pit with a paver circle at the walk-out ($5.7–9.6K) and a landscaping refresh ($3–30K, avg ~$12K).



Barn shore power

~$0.6–1.8K (est.)

14-50 (50 A) plus 30 A outlets for the van in the pole barn, off the existing subpanel.



Generator + lighting

~$9–20.3K (est.)

Propane standby generator ($7–14.3K) and landscape and drive lighting ($2–6K).



3D model · future guest suite

Phase 2: guest suite (~2 years out)

The idea

Optional ~560 sf studio (20 × 28 ft) on the chalet's west side: queen bed, plug-in kitchenette, full bath, private entry, lockable pass-through.

Only if we still love the property and want to keep investing.

Before designing

Written ruling from the township and county: addition or second unit. Propane tank moves (~$0.5–1.5K); septic review (~$1–25K).

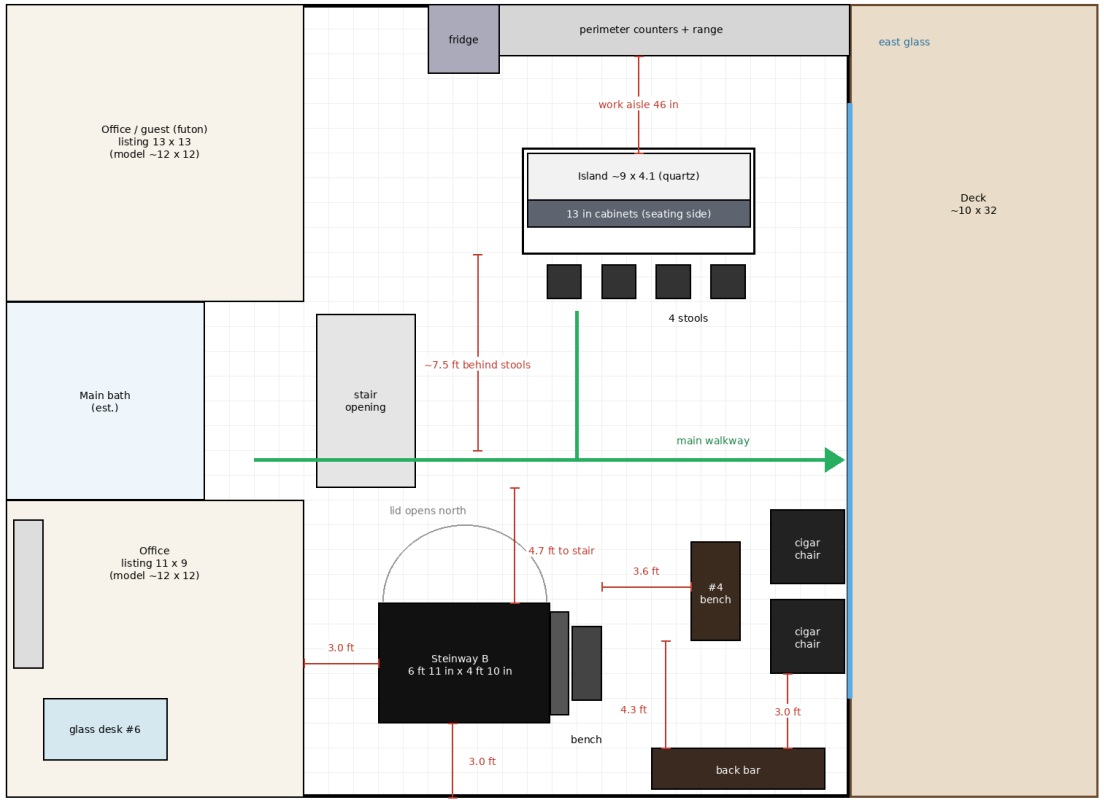
Phase 2 cost ~$140–290K (est.). Phase 1 + 2 ≈ $1.21M mid (est.), above the soft ~$1M target; see budget.

Seabreeze furniture: what moves, what's hard

Moves in: Steinway B (centered in the lounge as the focal piece; the stair spot failed), cigar chairs, bench and art panel (great room); glass desk + Aeron (small office); 75″ TV + console (lower); all gym gear (small barn).

Hard to fit: gray sectional (~12 × 10 ft L, verify; TV-room corner via the walk-out), massage chair (~32 × 60 in, verify; goes to the small-barn recovery room), Milan's full bed (loft now twin + queen; optional), kids desk set (donate or store), art panel (height not logged).

Next: measure each piece at Seabreeze, then the openings at Samels.



3D model

Main level, top-down plan

Rev. 2: piano centered. Model estimates (no floor plan on record); verify at the visit.

Budget vs. ~$1M target (soft)

Planning estimates, not quotes. Target ~$1M is soft; slightly over is OK. Purchase at the public list price (final TBD); excludes closing and moving. Optional, not in totals: gym bath $25–60K; 2 Powerwall 3 $24–32K; van-bay freeze protection $6–11K; Plunge cedar sauna $11,040 sale ($12,990 list) + 240 V circuit; aluminum or cable deck rail (quote).

Line	Range (est.)	Mid estimate
Purchase · public list price (final TBD)	—	$619,900
Interior remodel · mid incl. contingency	$115–315K	$187,000
Gym barn + recovery · permit, code, gear, climate control	$23.6–43.4K	$33,000
Deck + railings · clean + solid stain (brown)	$1–4K	$2,500
Ground-mount solar · ~20 kW in the field	$60–76K	$68,000
400 A service upgrade	$4–10K	$7,000
Extras · fire pit, generator, lighting, shore power, landscaping	$18.3–61.7K	$35,400
Tech & smart home · UniFi, Ring, Yale, ecobee, myQ	$8–12K	$10,000
Modern glass barn doors · 3 doors + header	$26–45K	$34,000
Phase 1 total · ~$3,200 under the ~$1M soft target		**~$996,800**
Phase 2 · guest suite addition (~2 years out)	$140–290K	$215,000
Phase 1 + Phase 2 combined	**~$1.14–1.29M**	**~$1,211,800**

Option deltas vs. base (mid, est.): flooring B gray porcelain ≈ +$15K (Phase 1 ≈ $1.01M, just over the soft target) · lower bath A ≈ −$25K · main bath B ≈ +$2K · loft bath B ≈ +$7K.

Next: measure, ask, then close

Measure at the visit

Lower bath + the room behind it

Lower bedroom window (egress)

Barn divider: posts on that line?

Deck width at the widest corner

Loft knee wall · walk-out slider



Ask Toni and the seller

Electrical service size, panel brand and utility?

Why was the 1999 pole-barn permit terminated? Any permits for the second garage or shed?

Septic age, size and permitted bedrooms; well depth and pump age?

Propane tank owned or leased? Road association fee and plowing?

Closing terms: traditional possession at closing, with the property vacant, all personal property removed, and in its agreed condition.

Second barn: needs an after-the-fact permit (Grand Traverse County Construction Codes).

Live 3D model and site: https://clarkhuang.github.io/5312-samels-rd/



Listing photo